Supplementary Material: State-of-the-Art Knowledge Distillation for Image Classification, 2022–2026

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S1. Search protocol

The inclusion criteria I1–I3 and exclusion codes E1–E7 (main text, Section 1) were fixed before the search started. All searches ran on 2026-11-08. The listings expose titles only, so identification is by title; abstracts and full texts were read at screening. Table S1 gives each search; the per-record logs (every listing URL, every title hit with its decision and exclusion code, and the full-text tables) accompany this supplement as `search/s1-cvf.md`, `search/s2-ml.md`, `search/s3-aaai-journals-arxiv-snowball.md`, `search/g-gap.md` and `search/manual-pdfs.md`.

Table S1: Searches, queries and counts. Identified: title hits screened. Full text: papers read in full. Included: methods meeting I1–I3 in that search, before de-duplication.

Search	Sources	Query	Identified	Full text	Included
S1	CVPR 2022–26, ICCV 2023/25, ECCV 2022/24 (official CVF/ECVA listings)	Case-insensitive title regex `distil|knowledge transfer|teacher|student`	656	96	37
S2	NeurIPS, ICML, ICLR 2022–26; TMLR (official listings)	Title match `distill|knowledge transfer|teacher`	985	130	36
S3	AAAI 2022–26, TPAMI, IJCV (Crossref, 2022-01-01 to 2026-11-08); arXiv cs.CV/cs.LG from 2025; snowballing from 24 papers' comparison tables	Six Crossref title queries (distillation, distill, distilling, distilled, "teacher student", "knowledge transfer"); arXiv abstract query "knowledge distillation" AND (CIFAR-100 OR ImageNet)	552	84	39
Second pass	The same listings and APIs	Broadened title terms (teach, student, mimic, soft label, dark knowledge, logit, temperature scaling); re-check of 29 cited works no search had included	445	13	+2
Manual	Papers no search could access	Retrieved by hand; 2 remain unreadable	–	15	+6

The three searches give 106 distinct methods after de-duplication (six were found twice). The second pass added CTKD and the projector study (SRD); two coordinator rulings removed LTKD (E4: CIFAR-100-LT only) and PE-BKD (analysis only). Manual retrieval added six methods, for 112. Two papers remain unassessable because no full text was found. An independent spot-check drew 22 inclusions and 30 exclusions; among the 20 of each whose full text was accessible it found no errors after adjudication (2 inclusions and 10 exclusions could not be read).

S2. All included methods

Table S2: All 112 included methods, top-1 (%) as each paper reports it. R8x4: CIFAR-100 ResNet32×4→ResNet8×4; W16-2: WRN-40-2→WRN-16-2; R18: ImageNet ResNet34→ResNet18; MBV1: ImageNet ResNet50→MobileNetV1. Fam.: L logit/loss, F feature/relation, S training scheme, R reliability, O optimizer/combination, H hybrid, DF data-free (its W16-2 value uses no CIFAR-100 training images and is not comparable with the other rows). Src.: table in the cited paper for the CIFAR-100 (C), ImageNet (IN) or data-free (DF) value. Notes: the variant behind the number and protocol flags. –: not reported or not extracted.

Method	Fam.	Venue	R8x4	W16-2	R18	MBV1	Src.	Notes
KD-AIF (Wu et al., 2025)	R	arXiv'25	82.20	–	–	–	C T2	C: teacher retrained to 86.56; not ranked
DeepKD (Huang et al., 2025a)	O	NeurIPS'25	79.25	78.42	73.34	74.85	C T1; IN T3	C: CRLD+DeepKD (stacked); IN: CRLD+DeepKD
VRM (Zhang et al., 2025c)	F	ICCV'25	78.76	–	–	–	C T1	
EA-KD (Su et al., 2025)	L	ICCV'25	78.38	–	71.99	–	C T2; IN T4	C: EA-MLD+LS (stacked, LS); EA-KD 75.46; IN: EA-DKD+LS; EA-KD 71.79
SKD (Jeong et al., 2026)	H	CVPR'26	78.33	–	71.13	–	C T1; IN T3	C: own KD baseline 74.75
LSKD (Sun et al., 2024)	L	CVPR'24	78.28	–	–	–	C T2	C: MLKD+LS (stacked)
UniKD (Huang et al., 2024)	H	ECCV'24	78.18	–	72.83	–	C T1; IN T3	
NCKD (Zhang et al., 2025b)	F	AAAI'25	78.18	–	72.44	–	C T1; IN T2	C: SimKD+NCKD; NCKD 77.23
TopKD (Wang & Zhou, 2025)	L	arXiv'25	78.18	–	71.52	–	C T2; IN T3	C: preprint; IN: preprint
SimKD (Chen et al., 2022a)	F	CVPR'22	78.08	–	–	–	C T1	C: reuses teacher classifier
FiGKD (Kim, 2026)	F	arXiv'25	78.05	–	–	–	C T1	C: preprint (ESWA)
KD-Zero (Li et al., 2023a)	H	NeurIPS'23	77.85	–	72.17	–	C T3; IN T4	C: distiller searched per pair; IN: distiller searched
TLLM (Zhu et al., 2022)	R	NeurIPS'22	77.83	–	72.6	–	C T2; IN T3	C: SFTN+TLLM (stacked); KD+TLLM 75.53; IN: teacher printed as ResNet32
GDKD (Zheng & Cheng, 2025)	L	arXiv'25	77.76	–	72.26	–	C T I; IN T III	C: preprint (TNNLS); own DKD 76.64; IN: preprint
Auto-KD (Li et al., 2023b)	S	ICCV'23	77.61	–	72.45	–	C T3; IN T4	C: distiller searched; 77.35 w/o logit KD
ADG-KD (Li et al., 2025b)	L	AAAI'25	77.51	–	72.22	–	C T1; IN T2	C: MLKD+ADG; ADG-KD 77.44
LumiNet (Hossain et al., 2025b)	L	TMLR'25	77.50	–	72.16	–	C T1; IN T2	
KD-AV (Peng et al., 2024)	H	ICML'24	77.47	–	73.04	–	C T1; IN T4	
GenDD (Cui et al., 2025)	L	arXiv'25	77.47	–	72.38	–	C T5; IN T2	C: preprint; IN: preprint
TeKAP (Hossain et al., 2025a)	S	ICLR'25	77.36	–	70.67	–	C T2; IN T3	C: MLKD+TeKAP; TeKAP(F+L) 75.98; IN: KD+TeKAP(L)
SHAKE (Li & Jin, 2022)	S	NeurIPS'22	77.35	–	72.07	–	C T2; IN T3	IN: multi-teacher variant 72.53
SAKD (Yu et al., 2026b)	S	arXiv'26	77.31	–	71.12	–	C T IV; IN T V	C: MLKD+SAKD; preprint; IN: preprint
AR-KD (Jiang et al., 2026)	L	arXiv'26	77.29	–	72.13	–	C T1; IN T2	C: preprint (CIKM); IN: preprint
WKD (Lv et al., 2024)	L	NeurIPS'24	77.28	–	72.49	–	C T11; IN T4	C: WKD-L+F; WKD-L 76.53; IN: WKD-L
Angular-KD (Yu et al., 2025b)	S	NeurIPS'25	77.28	–	71.07	–	C T2; IN T3	C: MLKD+Angular; KD+Angular 76.08; IN: KD+Angular
TGeo-KD (Hu et al., 2024)	L	ICLR'24	77.27	–	72.89	–	C T1; IN T2	
Ranking-KD (Guan et al., 2025)	L	ICML'25	77.25	–	72.06	–	C T2; IN T13	C: MLKD+ranking; repo unreachable; IN: NKD+ranking
BDD (Qi et al., 2025)	L	arXiv'25	77.22	–	71.97	–	C T1; IN T3	C: MLD+BDD; BDD 76.21; preprint; IN: MLD+BDD; preprint
EKD (Xiang et al., 2025)	L	ICCV'25	77.21	–	–	–	C T1	
LDRLD (Xu et al., 2025)	L	ICCV'25	77.20	–	71.88	–	C T1; IN –	
IKD (Wang et al., 2025b)	L	AAAI'25	77.10	–	72.20	–	C T2; IN T3	C: NKD+IKD; IN: NKD+IKD
MLKD (Jin et al., 2023)	L	CVPR'23	77.08	–	–	–	C T2	
NORM (Liu et al., 2023b)	F	ICLR'23	76.98	–	72.14	–	C T1; IN T3	C: NORM+KD; NORM 76.49
ReKD (Qu et al., 2026)	F	IJCV'26	76.94	–	71.72	–	C T1; IN T3	
DiSK (Kag et al., 2023)	S	ICLR'23	76.92	–	–	–	C T4	C: own KD baseline 76.25
CAT-KD (Guo et al., 2023)	F	CVPR'23	76.91	–	71.26	–	C T6; IN –	
RCKD (Wang et al., 2026)	L	AAAI'26	76.89	–	72.02	–	C T1; IN T3	

Method	Fam.	Venue	R8x4	W16-2	R18	MBV1	Src.	Notes
ERA (Yan et al., 2025)	F	arXiv'25	76.89	–	72.49	–	C –; IN T III	C: Ours-ST; preprint (TNNLS); IN: preprint
GKL-KD (Cui et al., 2026)	L	TPAMI'26	76.83	–	71.91	–	C T17; IN T5	C: extends DKL
MCD (Mishra et al., 2026)	L	TMLR'26	76.81	–	72.08	73.65	C T2; IN T4	C: +MLLD 77.45, +LS 77.11; 3 trials; IN: 3 trials
DiffKD (Huang et al., 2023b)	F	NeurIPS'23	76.72	–	72.22	–	C T9; IN T2	C: appendix table; IN: DiffKD† 72.49
UniADS (Lu et al., 2024)	S	AAAI'24	76.65	–	72.25	–	C T3; IN T4	C: student and distiller searched; IN: teacher 73.40
RLD (Sun et al., 2025)	R	ICCV'25	76.64	–	–	–	C T1	
FCFD (Liu et al., 2023a)	F	ICLR'23	76.62	–	72.25	–	C T1; IN T2	
DJIP (Chen et al., 2026a)	R	ICLR'26	76.61	–	72.08	–	C T1; IN T3	C: WTTM+DJIP; teacher retrained; IN: DKD+DJIP teacher
DKL (Cui et al., 2024)	L	NeurIPS'24	76.59	–	71.91	–	C T13; IN T4	C: IKL-KD
KCD (Li et al., 2022)	S	ECCV'22	76.48	–	72.13	–	C T1; IN T3	C: KC-SSKD; KC-KD 74.05; IN: KC-ReKD
SRD (Miles & Mikolajczyk, 2024)	F	AAAI'24	76.44	–	71.63	–	C T5; IN T6	C: SSKD teachers, RandAugment; 78.37 with SSKD rotations
DTO-KD (Hayder et al., 2026)	O	ICLR'26	76.40	–	–	–	C T2	
NKD (Yang et al., 2023)	L	ICCV'23	76.35	–	71.96	–	C T1; IN T1	
DKD (Zhao et al., 2022)	L	CVPR'22	76.32	–	71.70	–	C T6; IN README	IN: mdistiller
DIST (Huang et al., 2022)	L	NeurIPS'22	76.31	–	72.07	–	C T5; IN T2	
ND (Wang et al., 2024c)	F	ECCV'24	76.28	–	72.07	–	C T1; IN T2	C: DKD++; IN: DKD++
DIST+ (Huang et al., 2025b)	L	TPAMI'25	76.19	–	72.39	73.47	C T6; IN T3	C: adds feature loss to DIST
CutMixPick (Wang et al., 2022b)	S	NeurIPS'22	76.11	–	–	–	C T1	C: CRD+CutMixPick
PEFD (Chen et al., 2022b)	F	NeurIPS'22	76.08	–	71.94	–	C T5; IN T7	C: same in TPAMI ext. (T8); IN: TPAMI ext. T9
WTTM (Zheng & Yang, 2024)	L	ICLR'24	76.06	–	72.19	–	C T2; IN T5	
IPWD (Niu et al., 2022)	R	NeurIPS'22	76.03	–	71.88	–	C T2; IN T4	
CIFD (Saidutta et al., 2024)	S	NeurIPS'24	76.0	–	72.32	–	C T2; IN T3	C: one decimal; IN: 3 RDMs
DSKD (Liao et al., 2026)	F	AAAI'26	75.9	–	–	–	C T2	C: ReviewKD+DSKD; one decimal
TaT (Lin et al., 2022)	F	CVPR'22	75.89	–	72.07	–	C T1; IN T2	C: w/o KL term
RDD (Mugisha & Irakiza, 2026)	F	arXiv'26	75.58	–	–	–	C T1	C: single run; preprint
TopoKD (Kim et al., 2024)	F	ICML'24	75.40	–	73.60	–	C T1; IN T3	C: repo unreachable; IN: above its 73.31 teacher
MC-Distil (Tambat et al., 2025)	S	TMLR'25	75.38	–	–	–	C T1	C: multi-student; own teacher 80.10
DTS (Islam et al., 2025)	L	arXiv'25	75.25	–	–	–	C T II	C: MLKD+DTS; MLKD rerun 75.03; preprint
DOT (Zhao et al., 2023)	O	ICCV'23	75.12	–	71.72	–	C README; IN README	C: KD+DOT (mdistiller); IN: KD+DOT
ORC (Choi et al., 2023)	S	ICCV'23	75.00	–	72.00	–	C T2; IN T3	C: online KD; IN: online; pivot teacher
ADM (Chen et al., 2025b)	S	ICML'25	74.63	–	71.69	–	C T1; IN T9	C: SwitOKD+ADM; online KD; IN: offline variant
PLD (Bassam et al., 2025)	L	NeurIPS'25	73.97	–	–	–	C T1	C: own protocol (CE 71.56)
KDˆ3 (Tang et al., 2023)	S	ICCV'23	73.17	–	–	–	C T3	C: web-collected training data
ASD (Raza et al., 2026)	S	arXiv'26	73.13	–	–	–	C T1	C: own teacher 79.72; preprint
DistPro (Deng et al., 2022)	O	ECCV'22	–	76.36	71.89	–	C T1; IN T4	C: WRN pair only
BTKD (Zhang et al., 2025a)	R	AAAI'25	–	–	73.38	–	IN T2	IN: own teachers; Adam
BTKD++ (Zhang et al., 2026)	R	IJCV'26	–	–	73.38	–	IN T3	IN: extends BTKD
GPD (Guo et al., 2025)	S	ICLR'25	–	–	72.71	–	IN T1	IN: DKD+GPD; dynamic teacher
UHKD (Yu et al., 2025a)	F	arXiv'25	–	–	72.71	–	IN T3	IN: preprint
CoCaRS (Yu et al., 2026a)	F	arXiv'26	–	–	72.58	–	IN T7	IN: preprint
DPK (Qiu et al., 2023)	F	ICLR'23	–	–	72.51	–	IN T2	
SDD (Wei et al., 2024)	L	CVPR'24	–	–	72.33	–	IN T3	IN: SD-NKD
LB (Lin et al., 2026)	F	TPAMI'26	–	–	72.30	73.25	IN T1	
FBT (Li et al., 2025a)	F	ICCV'25	–	–	72.29	–	IN T3	IN: 100 epochs; repo 404
RPKD (Etcibasi & Cinbis, 2026)	F	NeurIPS'26	–	–	72.23	–	IN T4	
HCD (Xu et al., 2026)	F	AAAI'26	–	–	72.18	–	IN T3	
MSE teacher (Hamidi et al., 2024)	R	ECCV'24	–	–	72.16	–	IN T3	IN: ReviewKD+KD; 120 epochs
OFA-KD (Hao et al., 2023)	F	NeurIPS'23	–	–	72.10	–	IN T5	

Method	Fam.	Venue	R8x4	W16-2	R18	MBV1	Src.	Notes
MCMI teacher (Ye et al., 2024)	R	ICLR'24	–	–	72.06	–	IN T2	IN: DKD with MCMI teacher
AID (Qian et al., 2025)	S	ICCV'25	–	–	72.01	–	IN T4	
REDistill (Tybl & Neumann, 2026)	R	arXiv'26	–	–	72.00	–	IN T III	IN: preprint
Sort-KD (Limantoro, 2025)	L	arXiv'25	–	–	71.84	–	IN T II	IN: Sort-DKD; preprint
KDAS (Chae & Heo, 2025)	S	ICCV'25	–	–	71.81	–	IN T3	IN: DKD+KDAS
MGD (Yang et al., 2022)	F	ECCV'22	–	–	71.80	–	IN T1	IN: MGD+WSLD; MGD 71.58
e^2KD (Parchami-Araghi et al., 2024)	L	ECCV'24	–	–	71.8	–	IN T1	IN: equals KD at full data
SwitOKD (Qian et al., 2022)	S	ECCV'22	–	–	71.75	–	IN T6	IN: online
SRD (open-set) (Yang et al., 2024)	F	IJCV'24	–	–	71.73	–	IN T8	IN: uses unlabelled data
CTKD (Li et al., 2023c)	L	AAAI'23	–	–	71.51	–	IN T4	IN: DKD+CTKD; KD+CTKD 71.32 (own KD 70.83, DKD 71.13); gains +0.33 to +1.12 over fixed T (T1); CIFAR KD+CTKD 73.39 in LSKD T2
MasKD (Huang et al., 2023a)	F	ICLR'23	–	–	71.26	–	IN T6	IN: detection-first; appendix
CheckpointKD (Wang et al., 2022a)	S	NeurIPS'22	–	–	70.98	–	IN T1	IN: own teacher 73.86
KDCI (Wang et al., 2024b)	DF	CVPR'24	–	74.52	–	–	DF T1	DF: DFND+KDCI
CPNet (Chen et al., 2025a)	DF	ICCV'25	–	71.90	–	–	DF T1	DF: 300 epochs
NAYER (Tran et al., 2024)	DF	CVPR'24	–	71.72	–	–	DF T1	DF: 300 epochs
SpaceshipNet (Yu et al., 2023)	DF	CVPR'23	–	69.95	–	–	DF T1	
RGAL (Liang & Fu, 2024)	DF	IJCV'24	–	69.71	–	–	DF T1	
GapSSG (Wang et al., 2024a)	DF	TPAMI'24	–	68.88	–	–	DF T1	
FastDFKD (Fang et al., 2022)	DF	AAAI'22	–	65.12	–	–	DF T1	DF: Fast10
MAD (Do et al., 2022)	DF	NeurIPS'22	–	64.05	–	–	DF T1	
SSD-KD (Liu et al., 2024)	DF	CVPR'24	–	61.44	–	–	DF T2	DF: small synthetic set
HiDFD (Tang et al., 2025)	DF	AAAI'25	–	–	–	–	DF	DF: R32x4->ShuffleNet (version unstated) 75.03
VkD (Miles et al., 2024)	F	CVPR'24	–	–	–	–	–	R32x4->ShuffleNetV2 77.51
SoTeacher (Dong et al., 2024)	R	ICLR'24	–	–	–	–	–	W40-2->W16-2, own teacher
Bayesian teacher (Morad et al., 2026)	R	ICLR'26	–	–	–	–	–	W40-2->W16-2, own teacher
ABKD (Wang et al., 2025a)	L	ICML'25	–	–	–	–	–	CIFAR-100 in a figure only
PEFD (TPAMI ext.) (Chen et al., 2026b)	F	TPAMI'26	76.08	–	71.94	–	C T8; IN T9	

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